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d) Sacred & Profane

(10 Marks)

The concept of "sacred and profane" was given by Durkheim in his book, "The Elementary Forms of Religious Life".

Sacred

- Acc to Durkheim, ~~see~~ sacred is something which is considered holy, supernatural, extraordinary etc.
- It is something which is set aside for special treatment.
- Among different religions, priest is considered as sacred, religious practices are considered as sacred.
- ~~Sacred~~ Different groups considered different things sacred
 - Moral code as sacred (Buddhism)
 - God as sacred
 - Totem as sacred.

Thus, the concept of sacred is basic part of every religion.

Profane

- Profane is something which is considered as unholy, individualistic, ordinary etc.
- Profane is always kept aside from sacred objects.
- Profane are always inferior to sacred
- Different profane objects and activities are
 - Abusing a priest/pope is a profane activity
 - In some societies, "sexcr. are wildes" are considered as profane.
 - "Black Magic" is also considered as profane activity.

Thus, "Eric Wolf" said that through the concept of sacred and profane, the activities of members of society are regulated

Feedback

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